

# ANSWER KEY

*Podcast Worksheet — Why Do We Spend So Much Time on Our Phones?*

For Teacher Use Only | EFL Listening Activity | SMP Level | 3 Meetings

✓ **Green = Fixed / exact correct answer**

**Orange = Open-ended / sample answer only**

*Open-ended questions are marked in orange. Accept any response that is on-topic, grammatically reasonable, and uses vocabulary or expressions from the podcast. Sample answers are provided as a guide only.*

## MEETING 1

## Just Five More Minutes...

## A1 Match the Word — Vocabulary Matching

| Definition                                           | Correct Answer |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| The ability to stop yourself from doing something    | self-control   |
| To keep delaying something you need to do            | procrastinate  |
| Having the right amount of time for different things | balance        |
| Patterns of what you do on your phone every day      | digital habits |
| How long you look at a screen each day               | screen time    |

## B Before You Listen

| Question                        | Answer                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| B1. YES / NO questions          | <b>Personal responses — no fixed answer.</b><br><i>Accept any honest YES or NO.</i>                                                    |
| B2. What is this podcast about? | ✓ <b>B. Problems with spending too much time on phones</b><br><i>Students who answer A, C, or D should reconsider after listening.</i> |

## C While You Listen

## C1. Circle vocabulary words heard in the podcast

All 5 words appear. Students should circle all of them.

|               |                  |                 |                |           |
|---------------|------------------|-----------------|----------------|-----------|
| ✓ screen time | ✓ digital habits | ✓ procrastinate | ✓ self-control | ✓ balance |
|---------------|------------------|-----------------|----------------|-----------|

## C2. Fill in the blank

| N<br>o. | Sentence | Answer |
|---------|----------|--------|
|---------|----------|--------|

|    |                                                                        |                  |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1. | Person 2 says their ____ is much higher than it should be.             | screen time      |
| 2. | Person 2 often ____ because they keep checking their phone.            | procrastinate(s) |
| 3. | Person 2 says phone use has become part of their ____.                 | digital habits   |
| 4. | Both people agree that we need to find a healthy ____ with our phones. | balance          |

## D After You Listen

### D1. Complete the sentences (sentence starters)

| Sentence starter                                                    | Sample / Acceptable Answer                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. The main problem is that Person 2...                             | <b>Sample:</b> <i>spends too much time on their phone and cannot stop, even before going to sleep.</i><br><i>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.</i> |
| 2. This is a problem because it makes Person 2...                   | <b>Sample:</b> <i>distracted while studying and causes them to procrastinate and sleep very late.</i><br><i>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.</i>  |
| 3. Person 2 says the phone is hard to stop because it has become... | <b>Sample:</b> <i>part of their digital habits — they reach for it automatically without thinking.</i><br><i>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.</i> |

### D2. Prediction — which tips will appear in Podcast 2?

Items marked ✓ appear in Podcast 2. Items marked ✗ are distractors (NOT in the podcast).

|                                  |                                    |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| ✓ Turn off notifications         | ✓ Build a consistent daily routine |
| ✓ Set a daily screen-time limit  | ✓ Be more mindful about phone use  |
| ✓ No phone during meals          | ✗ Buy a new phone (NOT in podcast) |
| ✓ No phone while studying        | ✗ Delete all apps (NOT in podcast) |
| ✓ No phone 30 min before bedtime |                                    |

### D2. One prediction sentence — open-ended

**Sample:** *I think the next episode will talk about how to reduce phone use and set limits for ourselves.*  
*Accept any reasonable prediction. Bonus if student uses vocabulary from Section A.*



## MEETING 2

# Breaking the Scroll Cycle

## A Vocabulary — New Words

Section A in Meeting 2 is a study reference table only — no answers required from students.

## B Quick Recall — Meeting 1

| Question                                    | Answer                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| B1. What was the main problem in Podcast 1? | <b>Sample:</b> Person 2 had a problem with spending too much time on their phone / their screen time.<br>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.             |
| B2. Which tips did you predict?             | <b>Sample:</b> Any tips from D2 of Meeting 1 (e.g. turn off notifications, be more mindful, set a routine, etc.).<br>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response. |

## C While You Listen — Checking Solutions

### C1. Tick (✓) the solutions heard in Podcast 2

All items EXCEPT 'Delete your social media accounts' are in Podcast 2. That option is a distractor.

|                                      |                                                     |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| ✓ Turn off unnecessary notifications | ✓ No phone 30 min before bedtime                    |
| ✓ Set a daily screen-time limit      | ✓ Build a consistent daily routine                  |
| ✓ No phone during meals              | ✓ Be more mindful about how you use your phone      |
| ✓ No phone while studying            | ✗ Delete your social media accounts (NOT mentioned) |

## D After You Listen — Solution Analysis

| Question | Answer |
|----------|--------|
|----------|--------|

|                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D1. Prediction vs. Reality table         | <b>Sample:</b> Right column should mention: turning off notifications, setting a routine, being mindful, setting boundaries (no phone before bed / during meals / while studying).<br>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response. |
| D1. Was prediction similar or different? | <b>Sample:</b> Accept any comparison that correctly names at least one solution and explains whether it matched their prediction.<br>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.                                                  |
| D2. Choose ONE tip — why is it good?     | <b>Sample:</b> E.g. Tip: turn off notifications. Why: because fewer notifications = fewer times I stop studying to check my phone.<br>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.                                                 |

## E Useful Expressions

### E1. Fill in the blank

| N o. | Sentence                                                  | Answer                 |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| 1.   | I need to ____ — no phone while I am studying.            | set clear boundaries   |
| 2.   | One good tip is to ____ so you get fewer distractions.    | turn off notifications |
| 3.   | She decided to ____: no phone during meals or study time. | set clear boundaries   |
| 4.   | Having ____ helps you use your phone less automatically.  | a consistent routine   |

### E2. Write your own sentence using each expression

| Expression               | Sample Answer                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| set clear boundaries →   | <b>Sample:</b> I need to set clear boundaries with my phone: no scrolling after 10 p.m.<br>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response. |
| break the scroll cycle → | <b>Sample:</b> I want to break the scroll cycle by putting my phone away when I study.<br>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.  |

Scoring: 1 mark if the expression is used correctly in a complete sentence. 0.5 mark if the meaning is correct but the sentence is incomplete or unclear.

## MEETING 3

## Speaking Practice

## A Expression Review

## A1. Match the expression to its meaning

| Expression             | Correct Match                                  |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| being more mindful     | 4. Paying attention to your actions on purpose |
| turn off notifications | 5. Turn off phone alerts                       |
| set clear boundaries   | 2. Rules or limits you make for yourself       |
| a consistent routine   | 3. Daily plan you follow every day             |
| break the scroll cycle | 1. Stop the habit of endless scrolling         |

## A2. Which expression is most useful? — open-ended

**Sample:** I think 'set clear boundaries' is the most useful because I need to stop using my phone while studying.

Accept any expression + a clear, logical reason. Penalize if no reason is given.

## B Dialogue Template — Sample Answers

Suggested answers for the dialogue blanks. Accept appropriate, grammatically reasonable responses that use the expressions from the list.

| Spkr | Template line                                | Sample completion                                    |
|------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| A:   | Hey, you look _____. Are you okay?           | tired / sleepy / stressed                            |
| B:   | Yeah, I've been _____ these days.            | staying up late / spending too much time on my phone |
| A:   | Why? Is it because of _____?                 | your phone / social media / TikTok                   |
| B:   | Yes, exactly. I keep _____ and I can't stop. | scrolling / checking my phone / watching videos      |

|           |                                                          |                                                         |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A:</b> | <i>I think you need to start ____ . It really helps.</i> | <b>being more mindful / setting clear boundaries</b>    |
| <b>B:</b> | <i>That sounds good! Maybe I should also ____.</i>       | <b>turn off notifications / set a screen-time limit</b> |
| <b>A:</b> | <i>The goal is to use technology in ____.</i>            | <b>a more mindful way / a healthier way</b>             |

### Scoring guide — Dialogue (total 10 marks):

3 marks — Used at least 3 expressions correctly from the word list

2 marks — Dialogue is on-topic and makes logical sense

2 marks — Language is natural (not a word-by-word translation from Indonesian)

2 marks — Dialogue has at least 8 lines / exchanges

1 mark — Both partners spoke approximately equally (*assessed during role play*)

## C Role Play and Reflection

| Activity                            | Notes for Teacher                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| C1. Self-check                      | <i>Student self-assessment — no fixed answer. Use as a discussion starter after role play. Encourage honesty.</i>                                                       |
| C2. Easiest expression — circle one | <i>Personal choice — accept any. Use class results to identify which expressions felt most natural. Consider drilling the less popular ones more in future lessons.</i> |
| C3. One thing I learned...          | <b>Sample:</b> <i>I learned that having a consistent routine can help me use my phone less and sleep better.</i><br><i>Accept any reasonable, on-topic response.</i>    |